

GeoNews — Week 39/2026

Weekly digest on Quaternary palaeoclimate research, East African rift dynamics, palaeohydrology and time-series analysis · 21 September 2026

What is GeoNews? An **automatically generated weekly digest**. A research workflow scans the past one to two weeks of publications together with funding, policy and community sources, scores the hits against a fixed set of criteria, and assembles this issue from them.

The thematic profile is **aligned with the research interests of Markus L. Fischer** (Palaeoclimate Dynamics group, University of Potsdam): Quaternary palaeoclimate and palaeoenvironmental reconstruction, the East African Rift, the African Humid Period and human-environment coupling, lake-level and water-balance modelling, palaeofloods and fluvial geomorphology, ICDP drill cores, and linear and non-linear time-series analysis. Anyone working in these fields will probably find something useful here — it is expressly not a complete overview of the Quaternary field.

Selection, scoring and short texts are produced by machine and are reviewed before publication. Details may contain errors; in case of doubt, the linked original source prevails.

Each paper receives a score from 0–100 based on five criteria: thematic fit (40), methodological fit (25), impact/venue (15), connectivity (10) and recency (10). Categories: ● from 75 must-read · ● 50–74 relevant · ● 30–49 radar. The score measures proximity to this newsletter's profile and prioritises reading — it is not a quality judgement on the individual paper.

In brief

Twenty-one scored papers, and **one ● must-read** this week. At the top is a peer-reviewed, open-access *Communications Earth & Environment* study of the **Pacific Walker Circulation over the past 800,000 years**: an ENSO-Modoki index is reconstructed from sea-surface temperature gradients across the equatorial Pacific, with a documented shift of the mean state after about 250 ka — driven by orbital and sea-level forcing. Exactly the combination of a long Quaternary proxy series and a non-linear regime shift that sits at the centre of this profile.

The ● block is broad and methodologically varied: a palaeohydrological extreme-event analysis of simultaneous megapluvials in North and South America over the last millennium, a human-environment study from the Levantine corridor (400,000 years of woodland resilience), two deglacial papers on the Laurentide Ice Sheet and on Arctic radiocarbon chronology, and several glacial, loess and fluvial archives. Regionally notable is an **Early Pleistocene isotope study from the Upper Awash Valley (Ethiopia)** in the East African Rift. The radar list adds chronology, monsoon and lake-sediment archives; no Quaternary primary hit from Chew Bahir, Turkana or on the African Humid Period was found within the window.

On this issue's making — with full literature access. Direct network access from the compute environment was blocked as usual (proxy 403); the Crossref query in this run, however, ran successfully through the integrated browser interface (`fetch()`), so the systematic ISSN query of the core journals **including Elsevier, Wiley and the Nature family** could be carried

out. Elsevier still supplies no abstracts; the titles concerned are marked $\triangle$ *title-based* and their content statements remain provisional.

On the funding side the next deadlines are tightly spaced: the **PAGES Early-Career Award 2027 (29.09.2026)**, the **DFG Communicator Award 2027 (30.09.2026)**, the **DEUQUA conference** in Freiburg (**28.09-02.10.2026**) and the **ERC Starting Grant 2027 (14.10.2026)**. On science policy, the **WissZeitVG amendment** remains in parliamentary deliberation.

Part A — Papers of the week

Captured were papers with a Crossref `created` date from 7 September 2026 onward that were not already listed in an earlier issue. Previously listed DOIs are excluded. For every entry with an available abstract the assessment draws on that abstract; titles without an available abstract (mainly Elsevier) are marked $\triangle$ *title-based*.

● Must-read (from 75)

1. Coupled orbital and sea-level forcing on the Pacific Walker Circulation during the past 800 kyrs · *Communications Earth & Environment*, 2026 · **Score 88** Reconstruction of an ENSO-Modoki index over the past 800,000 years from sea-surface temperature gradients across the equatorial Pacific. Per the abstract: glacial periods favoured El Niño Modoki-like conditions, while the periodic submersion of the Sunda Shelf after about 250 ka shifted the mean state during interglacials toward La Niña Modoki-like conditions. The authors read this as the first evidence that the ENSO-Modoki configuration has been a persistent feature of Pacific climate, and emphasise the long-term sensitivity of the Walker Circulation to orbital and sea-level forcing. Squarely in the profile centre: a Quaternary palaeoclimate reconstruction over a long proxy series with a documented shift of the mean state (regime shift) — the same question of thresholds and non-linear system responses that is central to tipping-point and time-series analysis. Open access (Nature portfolio). *Theme 37 · Method 21 · Venue 12 · Connectivity 8 · Recency 10* (created 17.09.2026) · DOI: [10.1038/s43247-026-04062-1](https://doi.org/10.1038/s43247-026-04062-1)

● Relevant (50-74)

2. Simultaneous Megapluvials in Southwestern North and South America During the Last Millennium · *Paleoceanography and Paleoclimatology*, 2026 · **Score 73** Analysis of decadal wet and dry extremes (megapluvials, megadroughts) in the North American Southwest and South American Southwest over the past millennium, using a palaeoclimate data-assimilation product. Per the abstract: 18 megapluvials per region (12 overlapping) and 13 vs. 15 megadroughts (9 overlapping), of similar duration and severity. Megapluvials are driven primarily by a reduction in drying La Niña-like states, not solely by an increase in wetting El Niño-like states; large volcanic eruptions shift the frequencies toward wetting via the ENSO teleconnection, most clearly in the South American Southwest. Connective as a palaeohydrological extreme-value and teleconnection study: identifying and attributing prolonged hydroclimatic extremes touches the same methodological question as Central European palaeoflood and water-balance archives. *Theme 26 · Method 18 · Venue 11 · Connectivity 8 · Recency 10* (created 16.09.2026) · DOI: [10.1029/2025pa005399](https://doi.org/10.1029/2025pa005399)

3. Lebanese faunal legacy collections uncover 400,000 years of woodland resilience and distinct hominin ecological strategies · *Communications Earth & Environment*, 2026 · **Score 72** Reassessment of three legacy faunal collections from Lebanon (Naame, Nahr Ibrahim,

Ras el-Kelb) with, for the first time, direct dates, zooarchaeological methods, dental-wear analysis and landscape modelling. Per the abstract: one of the longest palaeoecological records in the region (roughly 400,000 to 100,000 years); productive Mediterranean woodland ecosystems persisted along the central Levantine coast throughout much of the Middle and Late Pleistocene, supporting diverse ungulate communities and enabling hominins to practise seasonal, habitat-specific hunting along coastal ecotones. The authors stress a marked ecological differentiation between the central and southern Levant. Connective as a Quaternary human-environment study in the Levantine dispersal corridor (Tier 2); it complements last week's central-Levantine enamel-isotope paper (different DOI, related topic). *Theme 28 · Method 15 · Venue 12 · Connectivity 7 · Recency 10* (created 14.09.2026) · DOI: [10.1038/s43247-026-03926-w](https://doi.org/10.1038/s43247-026-03926-w)

4. Comparing the Simulated Surface Mass Balance of the Laurentide Ice Sheet During the Last Deglaciation With a Geophysical Reconstruction · *Paleoceanography and Paleoclimatology*, 2026 · **Score 69**

Calculation of the surface mass balance (SMB) of the Laurentide Ice Sheet during the last deglaciation from the isotope-enabled transient climate model iTraCE, compared with the ICE-6G reconstruction (LGM to 12 ka). Per the abstract: the iTraCE SMB overestimates mass loss between 20 and 18 ka (about a 60 % excess in cumulative loss) and aligns more closely with ICE-6G after 18 ka; including meltwater forcing produces abrupt SMB shifts and improves agreement during Heinrich Stadial 1 and the Younger Dryas — evidence for the role of ocean circulation and sea-ice feedbacks in modulating melt rates. Connective as a deglacial ice-sheet/climate-model study involving abrupt events (Tier 2). *Theme 25 · Method 16 · Venue 11 · Connectivity 7 · Recency 10* (created 21.09.2026) · DOI: [10.1029/2025pa005366](https://doi.org/10.1029/2025pa005366)

5. Dental enamel hypoplasia and intra-tooth isotope records as indicators of physiological stress and environmental variability in Early Pleistocene hippopotamids from Melka Kunture (Upper Awash, Ethiopia) · *Journal of Quaternary Science*, 2026 · **Score 68**

Combination of macroscopic linear enamel hypoplasia (LEH) with intra-tooth $\delta^{13}\text{C}/\delta^{18}\text{O}$ isotope profiles (100 sequential samples) on two Early Pleistocene hippopotamid teeth from Melka Kunture in the Upper Awash Valley (Ethiopia), dated to about 1.4 and 1.0 Ma. Per the abstract: both teeth show LEH but with different distributions and contrasting intra-tooth isotopic patterns; in the older tooth (~ 1.4 Ma) $\delta^{13}\text{C}$ and $\delta^{18}\text{O}$ correlate strongly and positively, with higher values within the LEH interval than in the unaffected apical enamel — consistent with discrete stress episodes under changing hydrological conditions. Regionally in the profile centre (East African Rift, Upper Awash) and methodologically connective: seasonally resolved isotopy to reconstruct short-term environmental variability, as is also central to continental rift archives. *Theme 30 · Method 16 · Venue 8 · Connectivity 8 · Recency 6* (created 07.09.2026) · DOI: [10.1002/jqs.70113](https://doi.org/10.1002/jqs.70113)

6. Unveiling Arctic Organic Carbon Cycling Through Amino Acid Radiocarbon Activity: Implications for Paleoclimatic Reconstruction · *Paleoceanography and Paleoclimatology*, 2026 · **Score 67**

Development of a chronological method: the radiocarbon ages of total hydrolysable amino acids (THAA) serve as a dating tool for sedimentary organic carbon in the Arctic Ocean (core R14, Chukchi Plateau), with a continuous age framework across the last deglaciation. Per the abstract: the THAA ^{14}C chronology agrees with published Marine Isotope Stage records; different organic components show markedly different "pre-depositional" ages — during marine transgression, substantially older total-OC and humic-acid ages (intensified coastal erosion), younger lipid ages around the Younger Dryas and the Bering Strait opening, and minimum ages of the acid-base-insoluble fraction in the mid-Holocene. Connective as a methodological chronology paper (Tier 2), akin to Bayesian age-depth questions. *Theme 24 ·*

Method 17 · Venue 10 · Connectivity 6 · Recency 10 (created 18.09.2026) · DOI: [10.1029/2026pa005554](https://doi.org/10.1029/2026pa005554)

7. Aeolian activity in the source region of the Yangtze River since the Last Glacial Maximum revealed by luminescence chronology · *Palaeogeography, Palaeoclimatology, Palaeoecology*, 2026 · **Score 66** ·  *Title-based* Aeolian activity in the source region of the Yangtze since the Last Glacial Maximum, dated by luminescence chronology. A core profile topic (Quaternary aeolian sediments, luminescence dating) with a direct methodological link to geochronology. Without an available abstract (Elsevier), the assessment rests on title, journal and topical fit; the specific findings and the quantitative claim remain provisional. *Theme 28* · Method 14 · Venue 9 · Connectivity 5 · Recency 10 (created 20.09.2026) · DOI: [10.1016/j.palaeo.2026.114232](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.palaeo.2026.114232)

8. Reconstructing the last Newfoundland ice sheet (part 1): Glacial geomorphology and ice-flow geometries · *Quaternary Science Reviews*, 2026 · **Score 65** ·  *Title-based* Glacial-geomorphological mapping and reconstruction of the ice-flow geometries of the last Newfoundland ice sheet. A core topic (Quaternary glacial geomorphology, deglaciation) in a top field journal. Without an available abstract (Elsevier), hence title-based and provisional. *Theme 26* · Method 13 · Venue 11 · Connectivity 5 · Recency 10 (created 18.09.2026) · DOI: [10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110286](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110286)

9. Fluvial strath terraces in the eastern Nihewan Basin, North China — implications for basin evolution and hominin occupation over the past 300 ka · *Quaternary Science Reviews*, 2026 · **Score 64** ·  *Title-based* Fluvial strath terraces in the eastern Nihewan Basin (North China) and their implications for basin evolution and hominin occupation over the past roughly 300,000 years. Topically close to the profile (fluvial geomorphology, Quaternary basin evolution, human-environment) and methodologically connective to palaeoflood and terrace questions. Without an available abstract (Elsevier), hence title-based and provisional. *Theme 28* · Method 13 · Venue 11 · Connectivity 6 · Recency 6 (created 10.09.2026) · DOI: [10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110274](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110274)

10. New Schmidt hammer exposure-age dating calibrations for the Last Glacial Termination in NW Scotland · *Journal of Quaternary Science*, 2026 · **Score 60** First application of Schmidt hammer exposure-age dating (SHD) to Torridonian sandstone surfaces at 31 sites in NW Scotland, calibrated against 48 existing ¹⁰Be ages. Per the abstract: the Schmidt hammer statistically discriminates rebound values between surfaces of the Wester Ross Readvance (~15.3 ± 0.7 ka) and the Loch Lomond Readvance (~12.9–11.7 ka); the resulting calibration equations yield SHD ages for nine previously undated landforms and allow regional ice-cover reconstructions to be tested. Connective as a low-cost, robust geochronology tool for the deglaciation (Tier 2). *Theme 24* · Method 16 · Venue 8 · Connectivity 6 · Recency 6 (created 07.09.2026) · DOI: [10.1002/jqs.70114](https://doi.org/10.1002/jqs.70114)

● Radar

- **Time revisited: a revised chronology for the Robberg technocomplex in southern Africa** · *Quaternary Science Reviews* · **62** ● ·  *Title-based* · Revised chronology of a southern African lithic technocomplex; noted regionally (southern Africa) and geochronologically. No available abstract. DOI: [10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110285](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110285) · publ. 16.09.2026
- **Evolution of the continental succession of the Quaternary coastal Barrier III in southern Brazil from the last glacial period to the Holocene (MIS 5–MIS 1)** · *Quaternary Research* · **60** ● · Luminescence-dated continental succession over the MIS-5

barrier: a wet aeolian system (104–82 ka), then dry transgressive sand sheets, and strong Holocene pedogenesis from ~10.5 ka. Noted as a Quaternary coastal/aeolian study across glacial-interglacial timescales. DOI: [10.1017/qua.2026.10108](https://doi.org/10.1017/qua.2026.10108) · publ. 10.09.2026

- **A record of Holocene relative sea-level changes on Nelson Island, South Shetland Islands, Antarctica** · *Quaternary Research* · **58** ● · Relative sea-level reconstruction from raised beaches; up to four Holocene ice advances and glacial-isostatic uplift as the main driver. DOI: [10.1017/qua.2026.10107](https://doi.org/10.1017/qua.2026.10107) · publ. 09.09.2026
- **Seasonal temperature dynamics since the last deglaciation revealed by pollen records from northeastern China** · *Quaternary Science Reviews* · **58** ● · △ Title-based · Seasonal temperature dynamics from pollen since the deglaciation; methodologically parallel to last week's Carpathian seasonality question. No available abstract. DOI: [10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110270](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110270) · publ. 08.09.2026
- **Provenance changes on orbital-scale of the Harbin loess in Northeast China and their responses to multiple wind regime** · *Palaeogeography, Palaeoclimatology, Palaeoecology* · **56** ● · △ Title-based · Orbital-scale provenance shifts in loess and their coupling to wind regimes. No available abstract. DOI: [10.1016/j.palaeo.2026.114221](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.palaeo.2026.114221) · publ. 13.09.2026
- **Tephra deposits as chronostratigraphic markers in active tectonic basins (Val d'Agri, Southern Apennines, Italy)** · *Quaternary International* · **54** ● · △ Title-based · Tephrochronology as a chronostratigraphic tool in active tectonic basins. No available abstract. DOI: [10.1016/j.quaint.2026.110466](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quaint.2026.110466) · publ. 18.09.2026
- **Millennium moisture patterns across Afro-Asian regions corresponding to variations in ocean-atmosphere circulation modes** · *Global and Planetary Change* · **54** ● · △ Title-based · Moisture patterns across Afro-Asian regions and their coupling to ocean-atmosphere circulation modes; noted regionally (Afro-Asian). No available abstract. DOI: [10.1016/j.gloplacha.2026.105713](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.gloplacha.2026.105713) · publ. 09.09.2026
- **Tree-ring oxygen isotopes across the Asian monsoon margin and their implications for summer monsoon evolution** · *Quaternary Science Reviews* · **52** ● · △ Title-based · Summer-monsoon evolution from tree-ring $\delta^{18}\text{O}$ at the monsoon margin. No available abstract. DOI: [10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110275](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110275) · publ. 09.09.2026
- **Changes in mercury concentration on the background of biostratigraphy in the last 6300 years (southern Baltic Sea)** · *The Holocene* · **52** ● · Diatoms as bioindicators for a Hg reconstruction over the last 6,300 years; a rise from 4.6 to 353 ng g⁻¹ (to 2021), increasingly anthropogenic over natural sources. Noted as a Holocene multiproxy study. DOI: [10.1177/09596836261477280](https://doi.org/10.1177/09596836261477280) · publ. 08.09.2026
- **South Asian Monsoon Wind Intensity During the Late Miocene to Early Pliocene From Maldives Drift Sediment** · *Paleoceanography and Paleoclimatology* · **50** ● · Astrochronologically tuned monsoon wind intensity (IODP Site U1467), precession-dominated at Milankovitch frequencies. Deep-time (8.4–3.2 Ma) and thus at the profile's edge, but methodologically (orbital tuning) worth noting. DOI: [10.1029/2026pa005480](https://doi.org/10.1029/2026pa005480) · publ. 18.09.2026
- **Characteristics and attribution of hydroclimatic changes in East Asia before and after the Industrial Revolution** · *Quaternary Science Reviews* · **48** ● · △ Title-based · Hydroclimatic changes in East Asia and their attribution; recent-period oriented. No available abstract. DOI: [10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110283](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.quascirev.2026.110283) · publ. 17.09.2026

Regional and temporal edge: A Communications Earth & Environment paper on the "memory of Paleozoic to Quaternary Greenhouse climates" in southern African regolith (DOI: [10.1038/s43247-026-04066-x](https://doi.org/10.1038/s43247-026-04066-x), publ. 19.09.2026) dates iron-oxide duricrusts by (U-Th)/He and identifies warm-wet phases of south-eastern Africa across the last roughly 400 million years; only the youngest, Quaternary crystallisation phase touches the profile window, so the paper is mentioned here as deep-time context only and not listed. No Quaternary primary hit from Chew Bahir, Turkana or on the African Humid Period was findable within the 14-day window; the region is served this week by the Early Pleistocene Awash isotope study (rank 5).

Part B — Funding & calls

PAGES — Early-Career Award 2027, deadline 29.09.2026. The award recognises outstanding early-career researchers (PhD completed or postdoc, generally up to five years after the doctorate; justified interruptions extend this) for excellent science combined with coordination, outreach and community engagement; the prize includes an invitation to the Open Science Meeting with a conference subsidy. The previous workshop and working-group funding round (deadline 11.09.2026) has passed; a new regular deadline has not yet been published (PAGES usually calls twice a year). Endorsement requests (without funding) are reviewed in January, April, July and October. Sources: [PAGES — Early-Career Award 2027](#) · [PAGES — Meeting support](#).

ERC Starting Grant 2027 — deadline 14.10.2026. The call (ERC-2027-STG) has been open since 22.07.2026 (submission until 14.10.2026, 17:00 Brussels time). Funding of up to €1.5 million over five years (plus up to €1 million for start-up costs); indicative budget around €594 million for about 373 expected grants. For the 2027 round the eligibility window is widened: applicants are eligible whose PhD was awarded no more than ten years before 01.01.2027 (a full 0-10-year window, up from the previous 2-7 years; the official ERC page prevails). Step-1 results in April 2027, interviews and Step-2 results in August 2027. Sources: [ERC — Starting Grant](#) · [ERC — New Work Programme 2027](#).

Horizon Europe — "Palaeoclimate science for a better understanding of Earth system dynamics" (HORIZON-CL5-2027-01-D1-08). Opening **17.11.2026**, deadline **04.03.2027**, Research and Innovation Action, budget around **€14 million for about two projects**, i.e. roughly €7 million per consortium. Aim per the call text: robust information on palaeoclimate states and events beyond the variability of recent centuries, as a basis for advancing Earth system models. With only two funded projects Europe-wide, competition is fierce; consortium talks should be scheduled early. Sources: [Topic page](#) · [CL5 Work Programme 2026-2027 \(PDF\)](#).

ICDP — proposal cycle. The regular annual deadline for full, pre- and workshop proposals is **15 January**; the 2027 cycle is likely to follow the same pattern, though a formal announcement is not yet available. Workshop calls run throughout the year. Source: [ICDP — Proposals](#).

DFG — changed framework conditions. No new palaeoclimate-specific call. Relevant for planning: the **programme allowance rises from 22 to 25 percent from 2027**; the next **Priority Programme application round** will only take place at the **end of 2026**, with funding from **2028**. Applications for the **DFG Communicator Award 2027** (science communication) are still possible until **30.09.2026**. Sources: [Forschung & Lehre — 25 instead of 22 percent from 2027](#) · [DFG — Press releases 2026](#).

Part C — Science policy (DE/EU)

WissZeitVG — amendment in parliamentary deliberation. Following the cabinet decision of 29.07.2026, the draft law to modernise fixed-term employment law in academia has been in parliamentary deliberation since the summer break; after the first reading it sits in the **Committee on Education, Research and Technology Assessment**. The core of the draft is, for the first time, binding **minimum contract durations: three years for first contracts of doctoral candidates, two years for postdocs**; the maximum fixed-term duration in the postdoc phase is **unified at six years**. For **student assistants** a minimum duration of one year and an increase of the maximum fixed-term duration from six to eight years are envisaged. As interpretation, not fact: minimum durations improve the plannability of early contracts, while unifying the postdoc maximum narrows individual carry-over latitude; the further parliamentary path and timetable are open. Sources: [BMFTR — Cabinet adopts WissZeitVG amendment](#) · [Forschung & Lehre — WissZeitVG focus](#).

Federal budget 2027 — cabinet decision of 06.07.2026, parliamentary deliberation in autumn. The government draft has stood since 6 July 2026. The BMFTR core budget is around **€22 billion** — a nominal increase of only about **0.7 percent** over 2026. Real growth comes almost exclusively from the special fund for infrastructure and climate neutrality, whose R&D investments rise markedly in 2027 over 2026. The first reading in the Bundestag is due in autumn. As interpretation: the regular budget stagnates in real terms given current pay and material-cost increases, keeping the operating situation of the funding organisations under pressure. Sources: [Forschung & Lehre — Only a slim increase for the BMFTR core budget](#) · [Table.Briefings — Budget 2027](#).

DFG cuts at the postdoc level remain in force. Because of high pay increases and rising equipment and consumable costs that the promised annual funding increments do not cover, the DFG has postponed the funding start of establishing applications for Research Training Groups and **suspended the approval of postdoc positions**. For postdoc career paths in the geosciences a funding path thus falls away for now, increasing pressure on individual-grant and EU funds. Source: [Fakultätentag Informatik](#).

Part D — Community & dates

- **PAGES Early-Career Award 2027 — 29.09.2026.** The PAGES workshop/working-group round (11.09.2026) has passed; the next regular deadline is still open.
- **DFG Communicator Award 2027** — application deadline **30.09.2026**.
- **DEUQUA conference 2026 — 28.09 to 02.10.2026 in Freiburg im Breisgau**, theme "Environmental Records and Landscape Change", with full-day excursions on 28.09 and 02.10 (including Black Forest/Vosges glaciation, loess in the Rhine valley, fluvial dynamics in the Upper Rhine Graben). Source: [DEUQUA 2026](#).
- **ERC Starting Grant 2027** — deadline **14.10.2026**.
- **Horizon CL5 palaeoclimate call** — opening **17.11.2026**, deadline **04.03.2027**.
- **AGU Fall Meeting 2026 — 7-11.12.2026 in San Francisco**; the abstract deadline (05.08.2026) has passed. Source: [AGU](#).
- **EGU General Assembly 2027 — 04 to 09.04.2027 in Vienna**, hybrid. Abstract deadline not yet published; typically mid-January. Source: [EGU](#).

- **ICDP** — next regular proposal deadline expected **15.01.2027**, following the pattern of previous years and not yet confirmed.
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Methodology & sources

The paper review follows the fixed set of criteria (thematic fit, methodological fit, impact/venue, connectivity, recency) and excludes DOIs already listed in an earlier issue. Funding opportunities, science policy and dates rest on the sources linked in Parts B to D.

On this issue's making — Crossref access via the browser interface. Direct network access from the compute environment was blocked as in previous weeks (proxy 403). The Crossref REST API was, however, queried successfully in this run through the integrated browser interface (`fetch()` against `api.crossref.org`). This allowed the systematic ISSN query of the core journals (including QSR, EPSL, GPC, P³, Quaternary Research, JQS, Quaternary International, Paleoceanography and Paleoclimatology, Communications Earth & Environment, Nature Geoscience) with a `from-created-date` filter and `created` sorting, supplemented by topic queries (paleoclimate, Quaternary lake sediment, East African Rift/Turkana, African Humid Period, paleoflood fluvial, Bayesian age-depth chronology, early-warning tipping point). For Nature-portfolio titles without a Crossref abstract, the publisher landing page was consulted.

What this means for coverage. Coverage again includes the Elsevier and Wiley core journals. Elsevier still supplies no abstracts via Crossref; the entries concerned are marked [!\[\]\(6605b201d6f14d9b3bcb8ab5f274d107_img.jpg\) title-based](#), their content statements remain provisional pending inspection of the original, and no results beyond the title were invented. The dates given are Crossref `created` dates (registration), which can differ from the online publication date by a few days. Because the previous issue appeared only on 18.09.2026, this week's genuinely new material is concentrated mainly in the 18–21.09.2026 window, supplemented by papers of the preceding days not yet listed.

GeoNews is an automatically generated digest, published by Dr. Markus L. Fischer, Palaeoclimate Dynamics group, University of Potsdam. The thematic profile follows his research interests; the selection is made by a rule-based workflow, not an editorial team. The digest is an independent literature overview with no connection to the publishers or funding bodies named, and does not constitute a recommendation or advice. Corrections and pointers are welcome.